

T.A.L.O.N.

Client User Guide

Installation, setup, enrollment, Reticulum configuration, and field desktop operation.

Updated May 2, 2026 from the current PySide6 desktop code path.

Screenshots use isolated sample data and do not show live operational records.

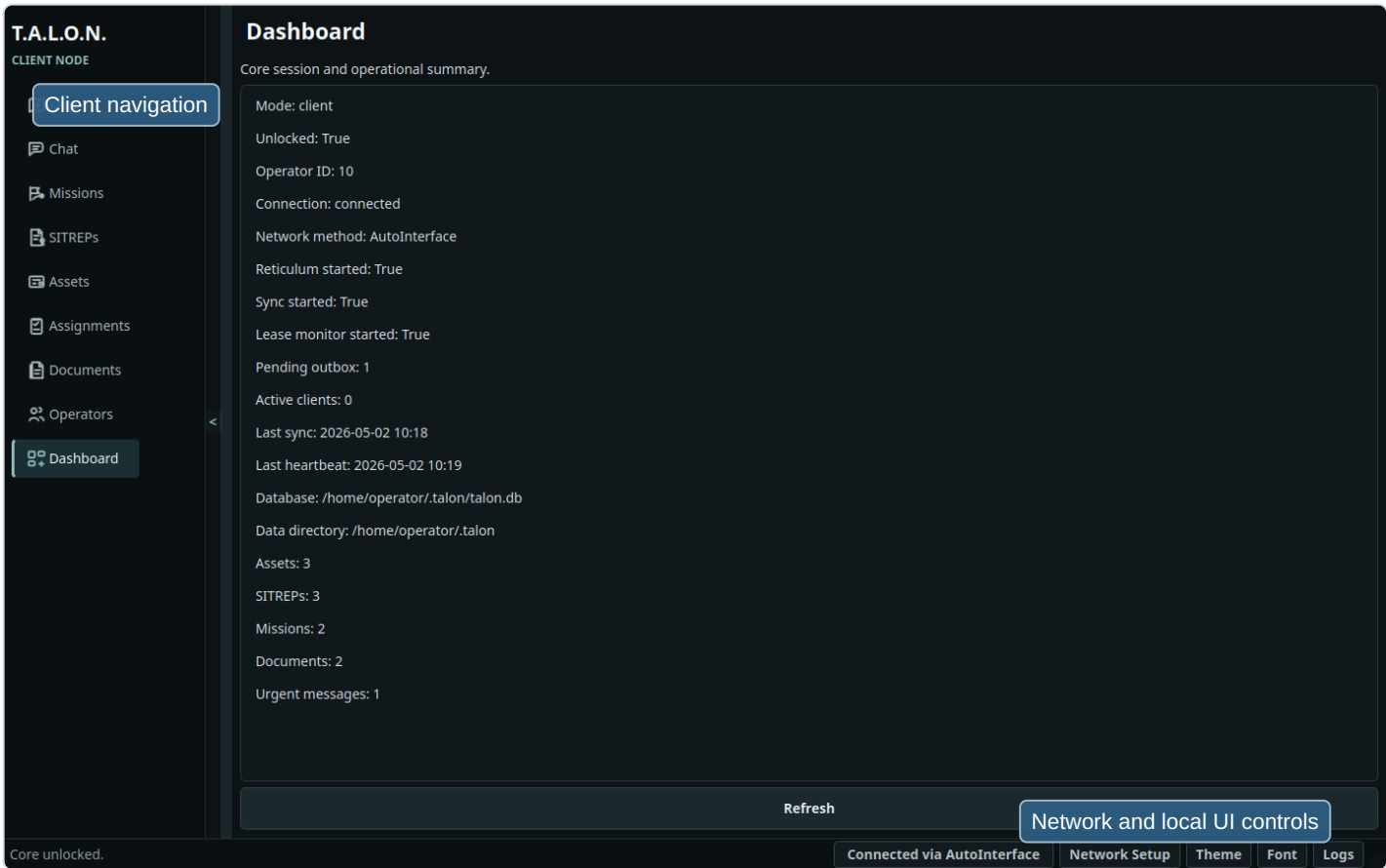
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- 2. Installation
- 3. First Run, Reticulum, And Enrollment
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- 6. Security And Data Handling
- 7. Troubleshooting

Overview

The TALON client desktop is the field operator interface. It unlocks a local encrypted database, enrolls to a server with a one-time token, syncs over Reticulum, and provides operational workflows without server-only administration pages.

Client operators can work with maps, SITREPs, assets, mission requests, assigned work, chat, synced documents, and their own operator profile. Server authority remains responsible for enrollment, lease renewal, revocation, audit review, key status, destructive deletes, mission approval, and document upload.



Client desktop after enrollment and unlock.

Installation

Install The Client Artifact

Use the client-specific Linux artifact. The installer reads the role marker from the extracted bundle and creates a client launcher, desktop menu entry, and desktop shortcut using the bundled TALON logo.

```
tar -xzf talon-desktop-client-linux.tar.gz
cd talon-desktop-client-linux
bash ./install.sh --yes
```

Installed Paths

Item	Default path or name
Launcher	~/.local/bin/talon-desktop-client
Desktop menu entry	\${XDG_DATA_HOME:-~/.local/share}/applications/talon-desktop-client.desktop , displayed as T.A.L.O.N. Client
Desktop shortcut	~/Desktop/talon-desktop-client.desktop
Data directory	~/.talon
Application config	~/.talon/talon.ini
TALON Reticulum config	~/.talon/reticulum/config
Document cache	~/.talon/documents
Launcher log	\${XDG_STATE_HOME:-~/.local/state}/talon/desktop-client-launcher.log

Useful Installer Options

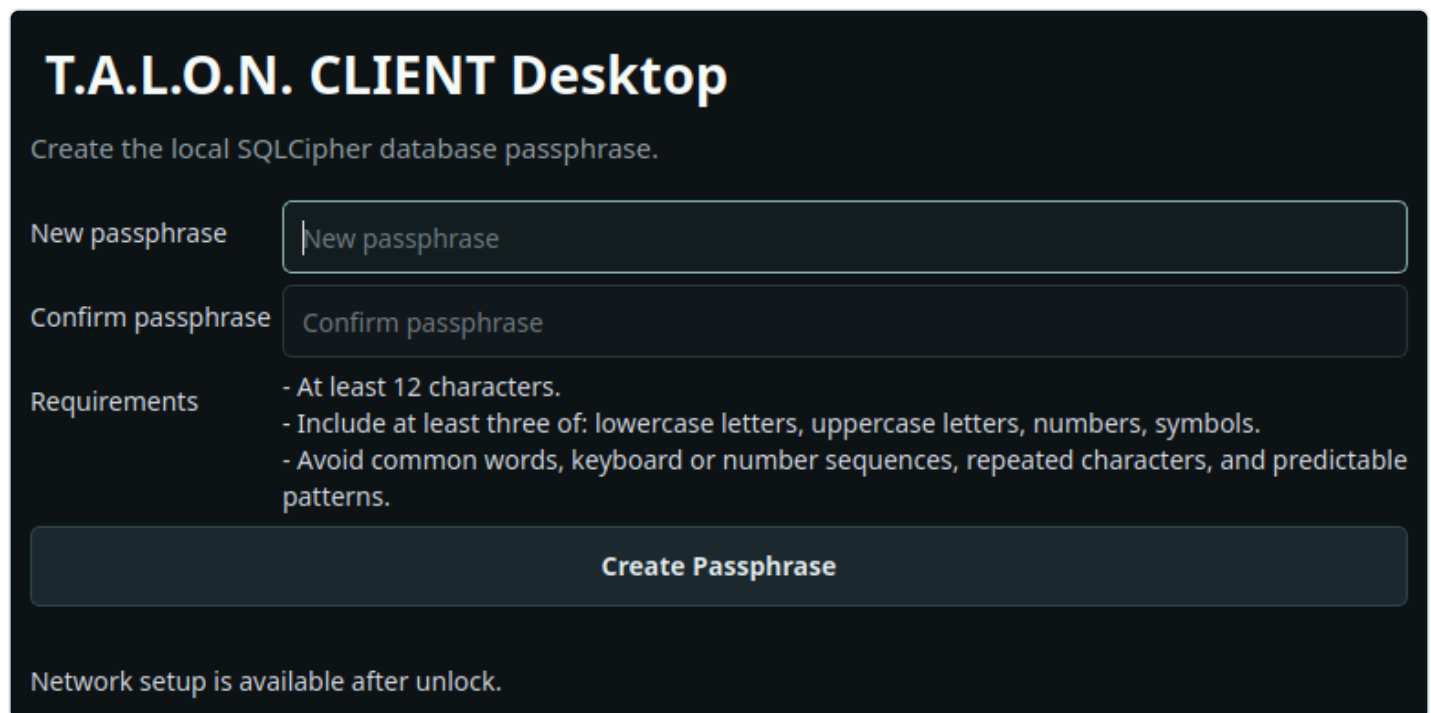
Option	Use
--yes	Assume yes for supported system package managers.
--no-deps	Skip system runtime dependency installation.
--no-bin	Skip role-specific launcher wrapper creation.
--no-desktop	Skip desktop menu entry and desktop shortcut creation.
--smoke-test	Run the installed package smoke test.
--uninstall --confirm-delete "DELETE TALON DATA"	Remove local TALON desktop files, data, identities, documents, logs, and launchers.

Role switch warning: a local user profile should not host both roles. Opposite-role cleanup and full uninstall require the exact phrase `DELETE TALON DATA`.

First Run, Reticulum, And Enrollment

Unlock Or Create The Local Database

Launch `talon-desktop-client`. On a fresh client with no local database, enter a new passphrase, enter it again to confirm it, review the on-screen passphrase requirements, and select **Create Passphrase**. Existing clients enter the local database passphrase and select **Unlock**. A fresh client remains on the unlock surface until Reticulum setup and enrollment are complete.



The screenshot shows a dark-themed window titled "T.A.L.O.N. CLIENT Desktop". Below the title is the instruction "Create the local SQLCipher database passphrase." There are two input fields: "New passphrase" and "Confirm passphrase", both containing placeholder text. Below these fields, under the heading "Requirements", are three bullet points: "- At least 12 characters.", "- Include at least three of: lowercase letters, uppercase letters, numbers, symbols.", and "- Avoid common words, keyboard or number sequences, repeated characters, and predictable patterns." At the bottom of the form is a large button labeled "Create Passphrase". Below the button, a message states "Network setup is available after unlock."

Client first-run passphrase setup window.

Configure Reticulum

Network setup is available only after the encrypted database is unlocked. The client uses a TALON-owned Reticulum config under the client data directory. Match the client template to the server deployment path.

Reticulum Configuration
TALON Reticulum config: /home/operator/.talon/reticulum/config

TALON Default
AutoInterface
TCP Server
TCP Client

Yggdrasil Server
Yggdrasil Client
i2pd Server
i2pd Client

Client config path

Choose the matching client transport

```

[reticulum]
enable_transport = False
share_instance = No

[interfaces]
[[TALON AutoInterface]]
type = AutoInterface
enabled = Yes

# Add TCP, Yggdrasil, i2pd, or RNode stanzas for deployment.

```

Reticulum config is valid.

Validate, save, then continue

Validate Cancel Save Continue

Client Reticulum setup after SQLCipher unlock.

- **AutoInterface** can discover peers on supported local mesh networks.
- **TCP Client** prompts for a server host and port.
- **Yggdrasil Client** prompts for the server Yggdrasil address and port.
- **i2pd Client** prompts for the server peer address.
- If Reticulum is already running, saved changes require restarting TALON before enrollment or sync uses the new config.

Enroll With A Server Token

A server operator must generate a one-time token. Paste the full `TOKEN:SERVER_HASH` value, enter the assigned callsign, and select **Enroll Client**. Enrollment requires the client Reticulum config to reach the server.

T.A.L.O.N. CLIENT Desktop

Unlock the local SQLCipher database.

Passphrase



Unlock

This client is unlocked but not enrolled.

Network setup is available.

Network Setup

Client Enrollment

Token

Paste

TOKEN:SERVER_HASH

SERVER-HASH-4D2A

Paste

Callsign

ECHO-2

Enroll after callsign entry

Enroll Client

Client enrollment prompt after unlock.

Main Shell

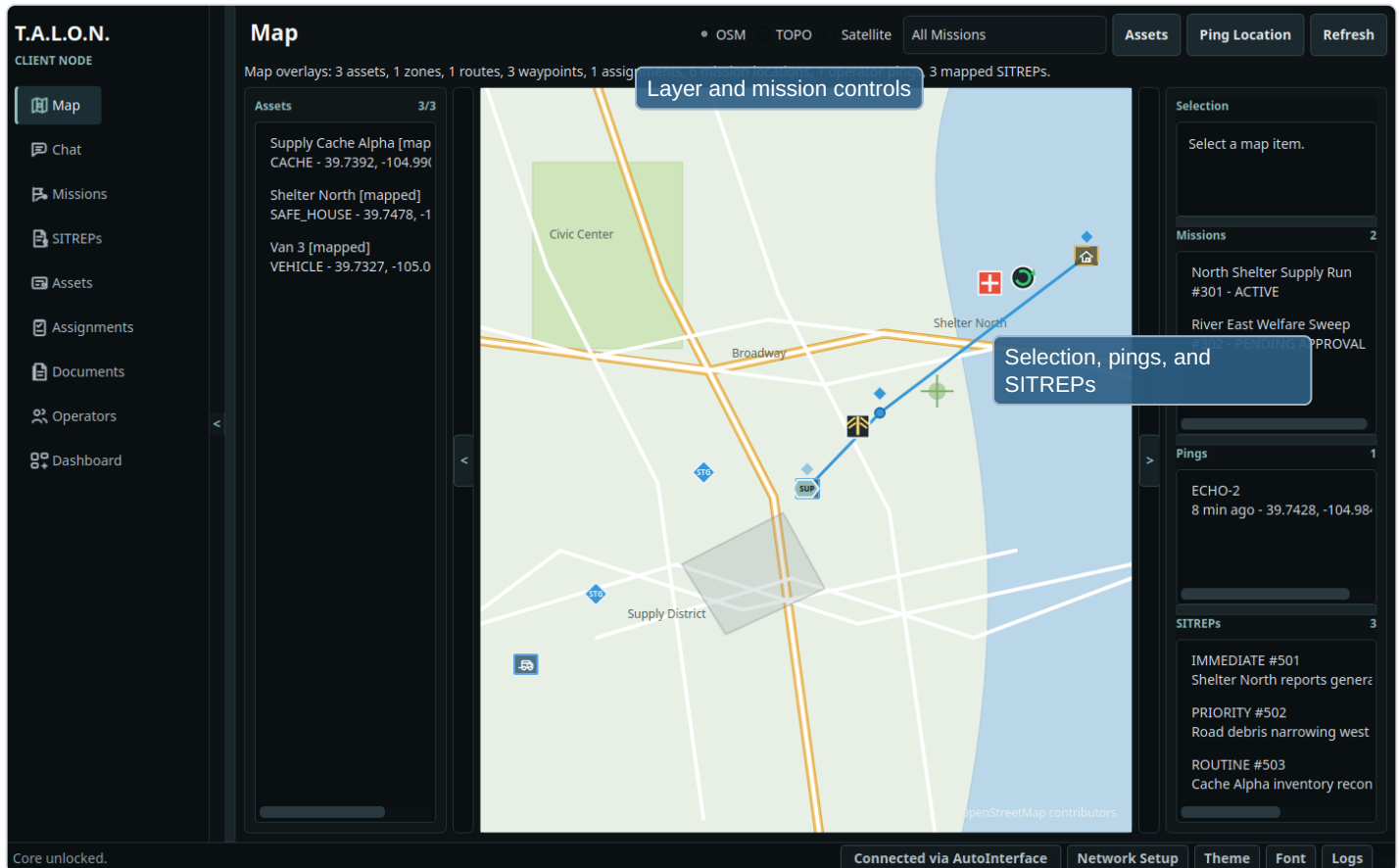
After enrollment, the client main window shows Map, Chat, Missions, SITREPs, Assets, Assignments, Documents, Operators, and Dashboard. Server-only Enrollment, Audit, and Keys pages are not visible in client mode. The status bar shows core unlock state, the redacted network method, Network Setup, Theme, Font, and Logs.

Unread badges: red-dot indicators appear for relevant updates from other operators. Local actions and server echoes of your own actions do not create unread indicators.

Screen Walkthrough

Map

The Map page shows selectable base layers and TALON overlays for assets, mission routes, mission locations, assignments, operator pings, and located SITREPs. Operators can focus a mission, filter visible assets, select overlays, and send a manual Ping Location marker.



Client map with fallback OSM-style background.

SITREPs

Client operators can create SITREPs, filter by severity, append follow-up information, and assign unresolved reports to available operators. Server-only delete is not shown. FLASH and FLASH_OVERRIDE audio remains opt-in.

T.A.L.O.N.

CLIENT NODE

Map

Chat

Missions

SITREPs

Assets

Assignments

Documents

Operators

Dashboard

SITREPs

New SITREP

Audio

Refresh

ROUTINE

0

PRIORITY

1

IMMEDIATE

1

FLASH

0

FLASH OVERRIDE

0

Pending

1

Level

All levels

Show closed

SITREP List

IMMEDIATE / BRAVO-4

2026-05-02 10:30

Shelter North reports generator fuel below two hours.

Location: Shelter North | Asset: Shelter North | Mission

Open

PRIORITY / ECHO-2

2026-05-02 10:45

Road debris narrowing west approach. Use east route.

Location: Broadway Checkpoint | Assignment | Mission

Open

Selected Detail

Open

IMMEDIATE SITREP #501 / DELTA-1

BRAVO-4 | 2026-05-02 10:30 | Open | Shelter North | Assigned: DELTA-1 | Mission: North Shelter Supply Run | Asset: Shelter North

Shelter North reports generator fuel below two hours.

Add information

Assign

Append

2026-05-02 10:40 Assigned

Assigned to DELTA-1. DELTA-1 checking fuel

2026-05-02 10:50 Note

Shelter has one spare can but needs delivery

Core unlocked.

Connected via AutoInterface

Network Setup

Theme

Font

Logs

SITREP feed and selected report detail.

Level

ROUTINE

Body

Shelter North reports generator fuel below two hours.

✓ Optional context

Mission

None

Assignment

None

Asset

None

Location

Shelter North

Lat / Lon

Latitude

Longitude

Pick on Map

Use Asset Position

Clear

• OSM

• TOPO

• Satellite

Click the map to set point.

Clear

Undo

Use Selected

Send

Cancel

New SITREP dialog with optional mission, assignment, asset, and map context.

Assets

Client operators can create and edit assets, type coordinates, or pick a location on the map. Client deletion uses a request flow; server mode performs final hard delete. Verification depends on authority and asset authorship policy.

T.A.L.O.N.

CLIENT NODE

Map

Chat

Missions

SITREPs

Assets

Assignments

Documents

Operators

Dashboard

Assets

AllRefreshNewEditUnverifyRequest Delete

3 assets, 2 verified, 1 deletion request(s).

ID	Label	Category	Verified	Delete	Mission	Location
201	Supply Ca...	Cache	Yes		301	39.739200,...
202	Shelter No...	Safe House	No	Requested		39.747800,...
203	Van 3	Vehicle	Yes		301	39.732700,...

#201 Supply Cache Alpha

Category: Cache

Verified: Yes

Created by: 10

Confirmed by: 1

Mission: 301

Location: 39.739200, -104.990300

Deletion requested: No

Water, medical, and radio batteries.

Core unlocked.

Connected via AutoInterfaceNetwork SetupThemeFontLogs

Asset table, category filter, and detail panel.

Category	Cache
Label	Supply Cache Alpha
Description	Water, medical, and radio batteries.
Latitude	39.7392
Longitude	-104.9903
Map	Pick on Map
CancelSave	

Asset create/edit dialog.

Missions

Client mode labels mission creation as a request. Mission requests can include requested assets, requested team lead, requested team members, AO polygon, route, timing, support notes, objectives, constraints, and key locations. The server approves or rejects requested missions.

T.A.L.O.N.

CLIENT NODE

Map

Chat

Missions

SITREPs

Assets

Assignments

Documents

Operators

Dashboard

Missions

AllRefreshRequest New Mission

2 mission(s).

ID	Title	Status	Priority	Type
301	North Shel...	Active	PRIORITY	Supply Run
302	River East ...	Pending A...	IMMEDIATE	Welfare Check

#301 North Shelter Supply Run

Status: active

Priority: PRIORITY

Type: Supply Run

Creator: COMMAND

Channel: mission-301

Team Lead: BRAVO-4

Team Members: ECHO-2

Activation: 2026-05-02 14:00

Window: 2026-05-02 14:00 - 18:00

Max Duration: 4 hours

Staging Area: 39.739800, -104.995000

Demob Point: 39.747000, -104.980500

Stand-down: Shelter confirms receipt.

Move supplies from Cache Alpha to Shelter North before night shift.

Constraints:

Avoid flooded underpass

Maintain radio check every 20 min

Phases:

Stage | Load supplies | 30 min

Deliver | Move to shelter | 90 min

Support:

Medical: Basic trauma kit staged at shelter.

Logistics: Two hand carts.

Comms: Primary: All Hands, backup: direct call.

Equipment: Vehicle straps and lamps.

Fuel | Van 3 ready

Objectives:

Delivery | All supplies checked in

Key Locations:

Command Post: 39.741500, -104.988000

Medical: 39.746800, -104.982000

Supply: 39.739200, -104.990300

Assets:

#301 Supply Cache Alpha

Core unlocked.

Connected via AutoInterface

Network Setup

Theme

Font

Logs

Mission list, status filter, and detail panel.

Create Mission

Cancel

Create

Overview

Timing

Assets

Area / Route

Support

AO Polygon

39.7364, -104.9960

39.7480, -104.9900

39.7460, -104.9770

Draw on Map

Route / Waypoints

39.7392, -104.9903

39.7420, -104.9870

39.7478, -104.9776

Draw on Map

Objectives

Label	Criteria

Add

Remove

Mission Location Icons

Command Post

Staging Area

Demob Point

Map target: AO Polygon.

OSM

TOPO

Satellite

3 point(s). Latest: 39.746000, -104.977000

Clear

Undo

Use Selected

Mission request workflow with embedded map drawing.

Assignments

The Assignment Board shows assigned mission and SITREP follow-up work, operator availability, unassigned work candidates, and pending sync. Client operators can open assigned targets, message assigned operators, and use available assignment workflows allowed by current authority.

T.A.L.O.N.

CLIENT NODE

Map

Chat

Missions

SITREPs

Assets

Assignments

Documents

Operators

Dashboard

Assignment Board

All assigned work

Refresh

Assign Operator

2 assigned work item(s). Assigned mission and SITREP work is shown here; mission planning, SITREP resolution, and map placement remain on their dedicated pages.

Assigned Missions

1

active or pending approval

Assigned SITREPs

1

unresolved follow-ups

Unassigned Work

2

needs an operator

Available Operators

1

not committed elsewhere

Pending Sync

1

local assignment changes

Assigned Work

missions and SITREP follow-ups

Target

Shelter North reports generator fuel below two h

North Shelter Supply Run

Operator Status

perators are excluded from assignment picker

Operator	State	Current Work
BRAVO-4	Assigned	Deliver Cache Alpha
DELTA-1	Assigned	SITREP #501: Shelter North report...
ECHO-2	Assigned	Deliver Cache Alpha
COMMAND	Available	Server Authority

Selected Work

target details

Shelter North reports generator fuel below two hours.

Type: SITREP

SITREP: #501

Status: Open

Priority: IMMEDIATE

Assigned: DELTA-1

Mission: North Shelter Supply Run

Location: Shelter North

Body:

Shelter North reports generator fuel below two hours.

Recent follow-ups: 2

10:40 - assigned

10:50 - note

Open SITREP

Message Operator

Reassign

Unassigned Work

next assignment candidates

River East Welfare Sweep

IMMEDIATE - Mission - Welfare Check | created 1 h

Road debris narrowing west approach. Use east roi

PRIORITY - SITREP - PRIORITY | created 15 min ago

Core unlocked.

Connected via AutoInterface

Network Setup

Theme

Font

Logs

Assigned work, operator status, and unassigned work.

Unassigned Targets

Sort

Priority

Target

River East Welfare Sweep

Road debris narrowing west approach. Use east route

Unassigned Operators

Operator

Status

Skills

Selection Summary

Select one unassigned target and one available operator.

Cancel

Assign and Message

Assign an available operator to unassigned mission or SITREP work.

Chat

Chat includes grouped channels, default channels, visible mission channels, custom channels, direct-message channels, urgent messages, grid-reference attachments, operator presence, and alert summaries. Delete controls are server-only.

Direct messages: DM channels are server-readable until end-to-end encryption is implemented in core. Treat them as operational messages, not private encrypted messages.

T.A.L.O.N.

CLIENT NODE

Map

Chat

Missions

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Assets

Assignments

Documents

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Dashboard

Chat

4 channel(s), 2 message(s) here, 1 urgent.

Channels

Search channels

MISSION

mission-301

SQUAD

logistics

DIRECT

DM ECHO-2 / BRAVO-4

DEFAULT

all-hands

all-hands | Default

10:00 COMMAND

Operational period begins at 1400.

10:30 BRAVO-4 URGENT

Shelter North requesting fuel update.

Grid: 39.747800, -104.977600

Message

Compose message

☐ Urgent

Send

Operators

BRAVO-4 online Team Lead

ECHO-2 online Field Operator

DELTA-1 offline Support

Alerts

URGENT: Shelter North fuel up

ECHO-2 | Field Operator

Core unlocked.

Connected via AutoInterface

Network Setup

Theme

Font

Logs

Channel list, message timeline, composer, operators, and alerts.

Operator

BRAVO-4 | Team Lead | online

DELTA-1 | Support | offline

Cancel

Open

Direct-message peer picker.

Search known positions

Type	Name	Latitude	Longitude	Detail
ASSET	Shelter No...	39.747800	-104.977600	Safe House #202
ASSET	Supply Ca...	39.739200	-104.990300	Cache #201
ASSET	Van 3	39.732700	-105.003100	Vehicle #203
SITREP	IMMEDIAT...	39.747800	-104.977600	Shelter North
SITREP	PRIORITY ...	39.742000	-104.987000	Broadway Checkpoint
SITREP	ROUTINE ...	39.739200	-104.990300	Linked to Supply Cache Alpha
WAYPOINT	Broadway ...	39.742000	-104.987000	Mission 301 waypoint 2
WAYPOINT	Cache Alpha	39.739200	-104.990300	Mission 301 waypoint 1
WAYPOINT	Shelter No...	39.747800	-104.977600	Mission 301 waypoint 3
ZONE	Flooded U...	39.736000	-104.992725	Hazard centroid #701

ASSET Shelter North 39.747800, -104.977600

10 known position(s).

Clear

Cancel

Attach

Attach a map position to a chat message.

Documents

Client mode receives synced document metadata and can download documents through the active sync session. Upload, repository management, and delete are server-only; the client UI displays that restriction directly.

T.A.L.O.N.
CLIENT NODE

Map

Upload is server-only

Missions

SITREPs

Assets

Assignments

Documents

Operators

Dashboard

Documents

2 document(s), 240.2 KB total, 1 macro-risk type(s).

server-only; clients receive documents through sync.

ALL DOCUMENTS

NAME	SIZE	UPLOADER	UPLOADED
shelter-supply-list.pdf	177.7 KB	COMMAND	2026-05-02
generator-checklist.docm	62.5 KB	BRAVO-4	2026-05-02

DETAILS

shelter-supply-list.pdf

Right-click this document to download it.

Foldermissions/shelter-north

Size177.7 KB

UploaderCOMMAND

Uploaded2026-05-02 09:53

SHA-256d2b21ab92219efaa33cb2298...

Current delivery manifest for Shelter North.

Context actions are server-only. Clients keep download and detail actions only.

Rename accepts Enter, Escape cancels.

Core unlocked.

Connected via AutoInterface

Network Setup

Theme

Font

Logs

Document repository in client mode.

Operators And Profile

The Operators page shows the enrolled operator roster and lets a client edit its own profile when permitted. Profile editing includes display name, role, notes, predefined skills, and custom skills.

T.A.L.O.N.

CLIENT NODE

Map

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Operators

Dashboard

Operators

Refresh

Edit Profile

3 operator(s), 3 active, 0 locked, 0 revoked.

ID	Callsign	Status	Role	Skills	Lease
10	ECHO-2	OK (48h)	Field Oper...	medical, n...	2026-05-04 11:00
11	BRAVO-4	OK (48h)	Team Lead	comms, lo...	2026-05-04 11:00
12	DELTA-1	OK (48h)	Support	mechanic, ...	2026-05-04 11:00

#10 ECHO-2

Display name: ECHO 2

Role: Field Operator

Status: OK (48h)

Enrolled: 2026-05-01 11:00

Lease expires: 2026-05-04 11:00

Skills: medical, navigation

RNS hash: echo-2-rns-hash-0123456789abcdef

Sample operator profile for guide screenshots.

Core unlocked.

Connected via AutoInterface

Network Setup

Theme

Font

Logs

Operator roster and local profile action.

Display Name

ECHO 2

Role

Field Operator

Notes

Sample operator profile for guide screenshots.

Skills

☐ medic

☐ comms

☐ logistics

☐ intelligence

☐ recon

☒ navigation

☐ engineering

☐ security

Custom Skills

medical

Custom skill

Add

Remove

Cancel

Save

Client profile and skills editor.

Lease And Revocation Lock

If the server revokes an operator or the lease state requires lockout, the client presents a modal lock window. Normal operation remains blocked until the condition is resolved by server authority or the operator quits.

Session Locked

This operator has been revoked. Local operation is locked.

Quit

Client lock state after revocation.

Security And Data Handling

Local Database

The client unlocks a local SQLCipher database. The passphrase derives the local key used for database and protected local material.

Network Identity

Reticulum identity material belongs in the TALON client data directory. Do not reuse a server Reticulum directory or another role profile.

Transport

TALON sync traffic uses Reticulum. The desktop reports only the transport family, not addresses, ports, peers, or device names.

Documents

Downloads are verified before save. Macro-capable office formats trigger a risk warning before opening or saving.

Direct TCP: direct TCP can reveal network addressing metadata. Use Yggdrasil, i2pd, LoRa, or a trusted VPN when address privacy matters.

Troubleshooting

Issue	Action
Application will not launch.	Run <code>talon-desktop-client --smoke --mode client</code> or reinstall with <code>--smoke-test</code> . Check the launcher log path listed above.
Enrollment fails.	Confirm the token is unexpired, the full <code>TOKEN:SERVER_HASH</code> value was pasted, the callsign is entered, and Reticulum can reach the server.
Network setup keeps appearing.	Unlock, open Network Setup, validate the TALON Reticulum config, save or continue, then restart if Reticulum was already running.
Document upload is unavailable.	This is expected in client mode. Server mode owns document upload and repository management.
Operator is locked or revoked.	Contact the server operator for lease renewal, revocation review, or re-enrollment guidance.
Direct TCP warning appears.	The active Reticulum method is direct TCP. Change to Yggdrasil, i2pd, LoRa, or a trusted VPN-backed path if address privacy matters.